



Notification Waiver Determination

Vets Central – Morley Veterinary Hospital

Acquisition	Vets Central Holdings Pty Ltd (together with its subsidiaries, Vets Central) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of 100% of the business assets of Morley Veterinary Hospital, as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	18 June 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Vets Central, is an Australian-owned veterinary group that owns and operates 82 first opinion veterinary practices across Australia and New Zealand. In Australia, Vets Central's practices provide core and ancillary veterinary services primarily for household pets as well as livestock and exotic species. The services primarily include routine, planned and emergency veterinary services (excluding after-hours services). The target, Morley Veterinary Hospital, is a full-service veterinary practice in Morley, Western Australia. It provides routine, planned and emergency (excluding after-hours) veterinary services for household pets (extending to exotic pets). Vets Central and Morley Veterinary Hospital both supply first opinion veterinary services primarily for household pets, livestock and exotic species in Western Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. there is no horizontal overlap between Vets Central and Morley Veterinary Hospital in the supply of veterinary services in the Morley area b. there are alternative suppliers of veterinary services in the Morley area and more broadly at the, state and national level.

	The ACCC has also had regard to the likelihood that, if the Acquisition were put into effect, the notification thresholds determined under section 51ABP(1) of the Act would apply. While the ACCC considers that the notification thresholds are likely to be met, given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
--	--

Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act